

Frederick Douglass Digital Square Web Migration & UX/UI Gamification

Web Migration: Daanial Haris, Josiah Altschuler, Kyle Johnson, Will Stroschein

UX/UI Gamification: Andy Chen, Andrew Zhang, Brandon Cartagena, Hanish Vadlamudi, Joshua Okeke



Website Migration Research and Platform Assessment (**WMRPA Group**)

Introduction - Our Team



Daanial Haris

Wix Site
Migration Specialist



William Stroschein

Google Site
Migration Specialist



Kyle Johnson

UMD DIT Point of
Contact



Josiah Altschuler

Client Point of
Contact

Project Background & Objectives

- Our client: Teresa Williams
 - Golden ID Fellow
 - Passionate about AA history
 - Wants to preserve history of FDS
 - To that end, she worked with INFO students to create Frederick Douglass Digital Square
- Statement of Work:
 - Determine how to migrate the website off of Wix, which is expensive.
 - Ensure that future curators can easily change and add to the website.

What is Frederick Douglass Digital Square?

Frederick Douglass Digital Square (FDDS) is a digital archive focused on preserving the history of Frederick Douglass Square and its namesake.

- FDDS caters to a wide audience, including:
 - Students
 - Researchers
 - The general public
- As with any project, there is a risk of losing access over time
- Need for institutional longevity (UMD support)
- **Goal: Preserve knowledge for future generations of Terps**

The Problem

- Ms. Williams originally created Frederick Douglass Digital Square on Wix
 - Pros: great tools, very capable for e-commerce.
 - Cons: Very expensive.
- Cost made it unsustainable
- Process of handing off to successor not clear
- Adding content was confusing and difficult

The Solution

We would:

- Research how to migrate off of Wix
- Figure out where to migrate to
- Provide a report explaining the process.



The Challenge: Things Go Wrong

Slight problem:

**You cannot migrate
websites off of Wix.**

This is obviously not ideal.

- Once we realized this was the case, we spoke with FDDS.
 - We were permitted to expand and change the scope to address these issues.
- Throughout this process, FDDS has encouraged us to think creatively and independently.

The *Actual* Solution

- Transition from Wix to a UMD-hosted website
 - This involved *manually* transferring content from the old site to the new site.
- Preserve and reorganize all existing content
- Ensure long-term sustainability
- Along the way, work alongside the UX/UI team to improve UX/UI for accessibility and usability

Recap: Our Options, Decisions, and Rationale

- In our first meeting, Ms. Williams stated her desire to reduce costs and increase ease of maintenance.
- All of the options below are free, but have pros and cons.
- Wordpress has the downside of using [**blog.umd.edu/yourwebsite**](http://blog.umd.edu/yourwebsite)
 - However, DIT confirmed that we could establish a vanity URL, so we chose to use Wordpress.

Features	Google Sites	Static Hosting	Wordpress	Drupal (Pantheon)
In a sentence	Simple and attractive sites for faculty/staff	Simple sites hosted by DIT using your URL	Familiar Wordpress experience, hosted by DIT using your URL	Manage content and provide complex functionality
Cost	Free	Free	Free	Based on monthly visitors, rates are available here
Order process	Self Service	Request from DIT	Request from DIT	Request a new Drupal (Pantheon) site
Best Use	Best used for intranets, team projects, marketing micro-sites for events or campaigns, organizing club meetings or activities.	Best used for HTML/Javascript websites. There is no database back-end to store data or forms, and no server side components like PHP or CAS.	Best used for less complex websites without workflows. Can support simple web applications .	Best used for departmental/college websites, with advanced workflows and multiple content editors/approvers. Can support complex web applications.
URL mapping	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Restrict access based on audience	Partially	No	Partially	Partially

Recap: What We've Done

1. Extensively researched alternative web hosting services to best meet FDDS' goals.
2. Successfully migrated all ~23 pages of content from the original Wix site, GitHub, and Google Site to Wordpress.
3. Worked closely with the UX/UI team to ensure migrated content aligns with UX/UI best practices.
4. Worked with DIT to implement a vanity URL, removing 'blog.umd.edu' from the default site URL.

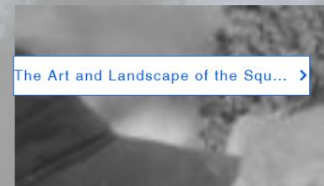
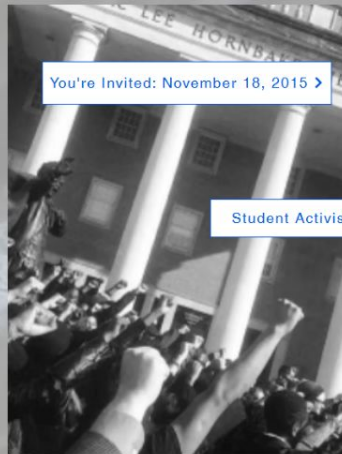
Top Level Page (OLD)	Page Name (OLD)	Including?	Top Level Page (NEW)	Page Name (New)	Done?	Location?
	Home	Yes		Welcome		Navbar Sliding Menu
Home	Douglass Himself	Yes	Welcome	Who Was Frederick Douglass?		Within a Page Sliding Menu
Home	Student Activism at UMD	Yes	Welcome	Student Activism at UMD		Within a Page Sliding Menu
Home	How did the Square get here?	Yes	Welcome	How Did the Square Get Here?		Within a Page Sliding Menu
Home	The Art and Landscape of the	Yes	Welcome	Art and Landscape of Frederick Douglass Square		Within a Page Sliding Menu
Home	Frederick Douglass Quotes re	Yes	Welcome	Quotes From the Square		Within a Page Sliding Menu
Home	You're Invited: November 18, ;	Yes	Welcome	A Moment in Time: Nov. 18th, 2015		Within a Page Sliding Menu
N/A	N/A	N/A	Welcome	What is Frederick Douglass Square?		Within a Page Sliding Menu
	Reflective Campus Journeys			Reflective Campus Journeys		Navbar
Reflective Campus Journeys	A walk with Frederick Douglas			Reflective Campus Journeys		Sliding Menu Within a Page
	The Frederick Douglass Square Adventure	Yes		The Frederick Douglass Square Adventure		Navbar Sliding Menu
	Resources and Citations	Yes		Resources and Citations		
	Land/Ancestral Acknowledgement			Acknowledgements		
	Acknowledgements			Acknowledgements		
Douglass Himself	36 Lisenard Street		Welcome	Who Was Frederick Douglass?		Within a Page Sliding Menu
	Contact			About The Curator		
	About the Project			About The Curator		

Welcome to Frederick Douglass Digital Square

[Take Stakeholder Survey >](#)

[Home](#) [Land/Ancestral Acknowledgement](#) [About the Project](#) [Student Activism](#) [Reflective campus journeys](#) >

This website is being developed with the support of a *Vital Signs: Creative Arts for Black Lives* mini-grant sponsored by The Clarice Smith Performing Arts Center, University of Maryland Office of Diversity and Inclusion (ODI), and University of Maryland Multicultural Involvement and Community Advocacy (MICA) in partnership with Black Terps Matter. [Learn more...](#)



Frederick Douglass Digital Square

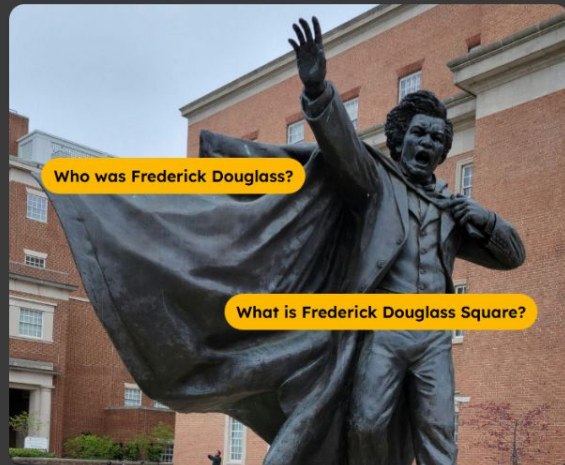
[Welcome](#) [Play the Game](#) [Reflective Journeys](#) [About the Curator](#)



Welcome to Frederick Douglass Digital Square

Frederick Douglass Digital Square is a web-based exhibit which explores the Frederick Douglass Statue and Square located in front of Hornbake Library at the University of Maryland, College Park. It is curated by T. Williams.

You can browse this Digital Square to learn about Douglass, the Square and statue; student activism at UMD; Douglass's connections to Maryland, Ireland and Britain; the artistry and symbolism of the Square; and hear an episode of historical fiction from the National Park Service featuring Douglass. Please enjoy!



Recap: Statement of Work

What we've done, item-by-item

- Project Initiation and Requirements Clarification
- Platform Research and Comparison
- University of Maryland Resource Assessment
- Migration Considerations and Constraints
- Synthesis and Recommendation Development
- + Performed Migration (**not in SOW**)
- Final Presentation
- Final Project Activities (next slide)

Next Steps (Website Migration)

- Meet with FDDS regarding DIT and long-term website maintenance.
- Walk FDDS through managing ownership on the hosting portal
- Finalize creation of video-based documentation

Questions?

- Feel free to direct any Website Migration-related questions to the following emails:
 - Daanial Haris (Wix Site Migration Specialist):
 - ddharis@terpmail.umd.edu
 - Will Stro (Google Site Migration Specialist):
 - willstro@terpmail.umd.edu
 - Kyle Johnson (UMD DIT Point of Contact):
 - kylej008@terpmail.umd.edu
 - Josiah Altschuler (Client Point of Contact):
 - jalts@terpmail.umd.edu

UX/UI Gamification Research

Phase II

(UIGR Group)

Introduction - Our Team



Andy Chen
Site Designer
Game Programmer



Joshua Okeke
User Testing
Researcher



Andrew Zhang
Project Manager
UI/UX Tester



Hanish Vadlamudi
User Testing
Researcher



Brandon Cartagena
Client Contact
Game Programmer

The Problems

- Existing UX/UI of website was difficult to navigate
 - Poor structure
 - Did not follow important UX/UI best practices
 - Game was hard to find
- The sliding puzzle was hard or impossible for users to complete
- Overall, the existing website left much to be desired in terms of UX and UI.

The Solutions

Frederick Douglass Digital Square Website

- Global navigation buttons reduced
- Multiple smaller changes (we will cover these shortly)
- Site-wide use of yellow and black motif

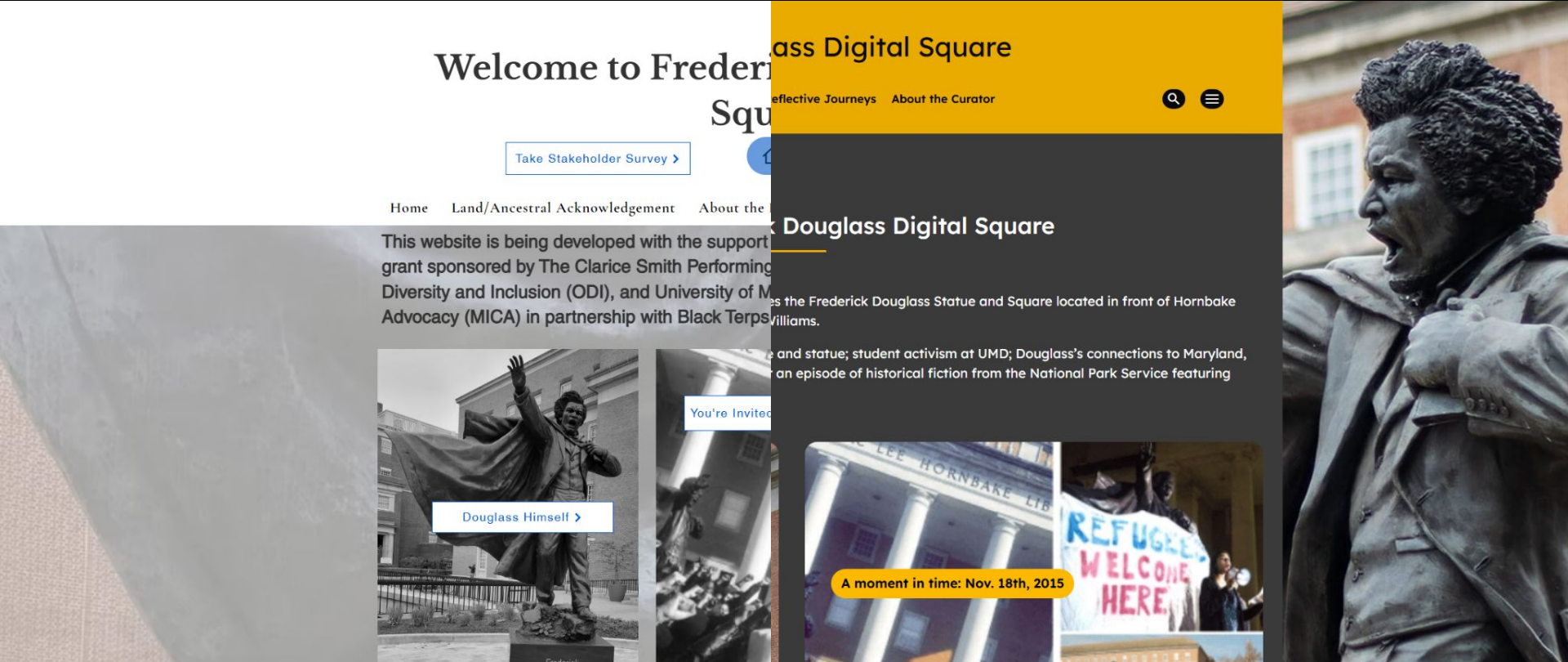
Frederick Douglass Adventure Game

- Made the game more visible by making it front and center on the global navigation bar.
- Changed the sliding puzzle game to a jigsaw puzzle

The Challenges

- Parsing the site's pages: Finding and auditing all pages from across the original site's disparate locations.
 - wix.com, sites.google.com, and github.io
- Organization: Transforming the original navigation bar into a modern, logical structure.
- GDevelop: Learning the game engine on which the Frederick Douglass Adventure game is built on
- The biggest challenge was implementing the jigsaw game. Due to the nature of the game engine, it was difficult to properly make the jigsaw puzzle

Progress and Deliverables (Live Demo)



Recap: What We've Done

1. Researched and tested user experience
2. Updated UI and tested UX to test accessibility on current site
3. Researched GDevelop5 to create Jigsaw Puzzle

Frederick Douglass Digital Square

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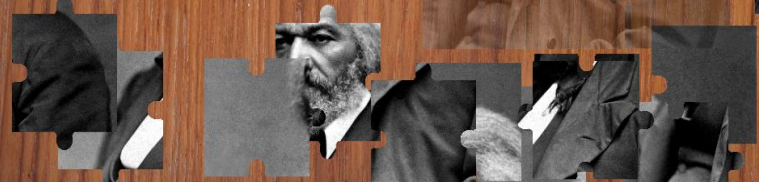
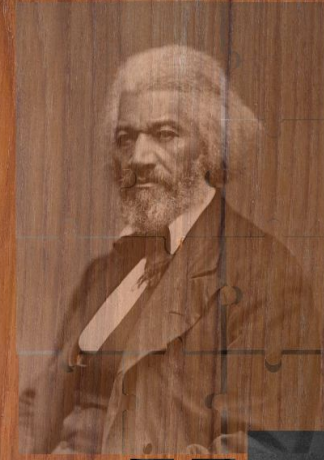
You can browse this Digital Square to learn about Douglass, the Square and statue; student activism at UMD; Douglass's connections to Maryland, Ireland and Britain; the artistry and symbolism of the Square; and hear an episode of historical fiction from the National Park Service featuring Douglass. Please enjoy!

Who was Frederick Douglass?

What is Frederick Douglass Square?

A moment in time: Nov. 18th, 2015

Student activism at UMD



Recap: Statement of Work

What we've done, item-by-item

- Initial Project Briefing
- Evaluation of Existing Gamified Experience
- + Evaluation of Existing Web Design (not in SOW)
- Iterative Design and Refinement (Game)
- + Iterative Design and Refinement (Website, not in SOW)
- Final presentation
- User Research and Testing
- Final report on project outcomes

Next Steps (UX/UI Gamification)

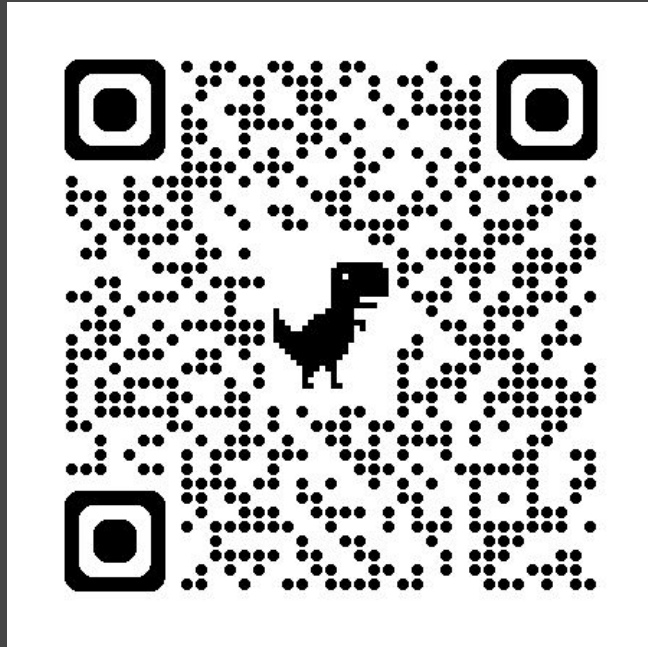
Main Goals

- Perform additional game testing and patch any outstanding bugs or issues with the FDDS Adventure Game
- Perform user testing and gather user feedback about the reworked game mechanic
- Also gather feedback about new UX/UI redesign, allowing users to compare and contrast between old and new site.
- Provide these findings in a final report to FDDS.

Questions?

- Feel free to direct any Website Migration-related questions to the following emails:
 - Brandon Cartagena (Client Contact, Game Programmer):
 - brancart@terpmail.umd.edu
 - Andy Chen (Site Designer, Game Programmer):
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 - Andrew Zhang (Project Manager, UX/UI Tester):
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 - Hanish Vadlamudi (User Testing Researcher):
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 - Joshua Okeke (User Testing Researcher):
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frederickdouglass.umd.edu



**Thank you for a great
semester and project! :D**